

Title: Prompt Engineering Comparison: Zero Shot vs Few-Shot Prompts

Objective: Comparing Zero Shot vs Few Shot Prompts for clarifying Customer Support Messages

Table for Test Messages:

No.	Customer Message	Correct Label
1	My order arrived three days late	Complaint
2	How can I reset my password ?	Question
3	Your support team was incredible and helped me a lot.	Praise
4	The app keeps crashing everytime I open it.	Complaint
5	Do you offer International Shipping ?	Question
6	I'm very happy with the quality of your product	Praise
7	I received the wrong item in my package	Complaint
8	Can I change my delivery address after ordering ?	Question
9	Thank you for the quick response and excellent service.	Praise
10	The website is extremely slow and difficult to use.	Complaint

Zero-Shot Prompt

You are a customer support assistant.

Classify each of the following into one correct label.

- Complaint
- Question
- Praise

Return your answer showing the category only.

Few-Shot Prompt

You are a customer support assistant. Classify each of the following into one correct label:

- Complaint
- Question
- Praise

Examples:

Message: My package hasn't arrived yet and it's been two days more than the Estimated Time of Delivery.

Category: Complaint

Message: Do you accept the Jazzcash method for online payment ?

Category: Question

Message: I really like how faast your support service is, I'm thoroughly impressed!

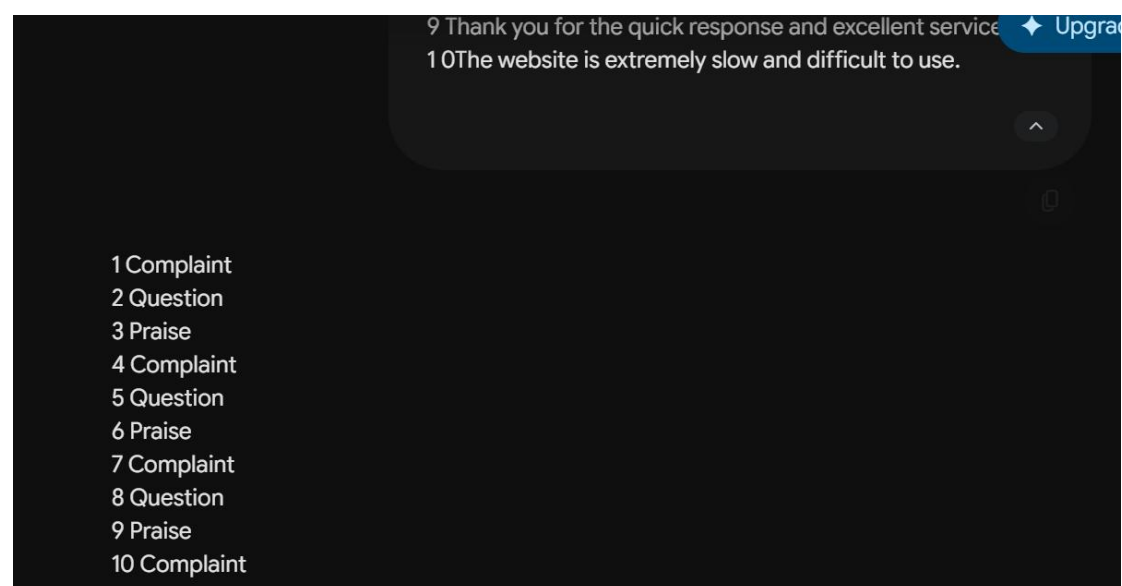
Category: Praise

Now classify using this format.

AI OUTPUTS

1. Google Gemini

Zero Shot Prompt



Few-Shot Prompt

Message: 1 My order arrived two days late.

Category: Complaint

Message: 2 How can I reset my password?

Category: Question

Message: 3 Your support team was incredibly helpful.

Category: Praise

Message: 4 The app keeps crashing every time I open it.

Category: Complaint

Message: 5 Do you offer international shipping?

Category: Question

Message: 6 I'm very happy with the quality of your product.

Category: Praise

Message: 7 I received the wrong item in my package.

Category: Complaint

Accuracy: 10/10 (100%)

2. ChatGPT

Zero Shot Prompt

ChatGPT ▾

Return your answers in a numbered list with category for each message.
Question
Show more ▾

1. Complaint
2. Question
3. Praise
4. Complaint
5. Question
6. Praise
7. Complaint
8. Question
9. Praise
10. Complaint

Few-Shot Prompt



The screenshot displays a dark-themed interface with a list of 8 numbered examples. Each example consists of a user query and a corresponding category label. A circular arrow icon is visible on the right side of the list.

1. My order arrived two days late.
Category: Complaint
2. How can I reset my password?
Category: Question
3. Your support team was incredibly helpful.
Category: Praise
4. The app keeps crashing every time I open it.
Category: Complaint
5. Do you offer international shipping?
Category: Question
6. I'm very happy with the quality of your product.
Category: Praise
7. I received the wrong item in my package.
Category: Complaint
8. Can I change my delivery address after ordering?
Category: Question

Accuracy: 10/10 (100%)

3. Claude

Zero Shot Prompt

Thought for 3s

1. Complaint
2. Question
3. Praise
4. Complaint
5. Question
6. Praise
7. Complaint
8. Question
9. Praise
10. Complaint

Want to be notified when Claude responds?

Few-Shot Prompt

1. Message: My order arrived two days late.
Category: Complaint
2. Message: How can I reset my password?
Category: Question
3. Message: Your support team was incredibly helpful.
Category: Praise
4. Message: The app keeps crashing every time I open it.
Category: Complaint
5. Message: Do you offer international shipping?
Category: Question
6. Message: I'm very happy with the quality of your product.
Category: Praise
7. Message: I received the wrong item in my package.
Category: Complaint

Accuracy: 10/10 (100%)

Conclusion

Few-shot prompting provides the model with labeled examples before the task, helping it better understand the expected output format and classification criteria. In this simple classification task, both zero-shot and few-shot prompting achieved perfect accuracy across ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini because the messages were clear and unambiguous. However, few-shot prompting is generally more reliable for complex or ambiguous tasks since the examples reduce misunderstanding and encourage more consistent responses. For real-world datasets with subtle differences between categories, few-shot prompting would likely outperform zero-shot prompting.